

Glance Help

Glance is a portable Markdown editor with a folder tree, tabbed editor, and rendered preview.

Opening Folders

Use **File > Open Folder** to choose a folder. Glance scans the folder recursively and shows Markdown files in the left tree.

Supported file types:

- `.md`
- `.markdown`
- `.mdown`
- `.mkd`

Hidden files and folders are skipped by default.

Opening Files

Open a file by double-clicking it in the file tree, or use **File > Open File**. If the file is already open, Glance switches to the existing tab.

You can also launch Glance with a folder or Markdown file path:

```
glance /path/to/folder
glance /path/to/file.md
```

Editing And Saving

Each Markdown file opens in its own tab. Modified files show an asterisk before the tab name.

Use:

- **File > Save File** to save the current tab.
- **File > Save All** to save all modified tabs.
- **File > Close Tab** to close the current tab.

When closing a modified tab, switching folders, or exiting the app, Glance asks whether to

save changes. Document editing, insertion, saving, closing, preview export, and printing commands are disabled when no document is open.

Preview

The right pane shows a rendered preview of the active Markdown tab. The preview updates automatically after a short debounce when you type.

The preview supports common Markdown structures:

- Headings
- Paragraphs
- Emphasis and strong text
- Strikethrough
- Lists and task lists
- Code blocks and inline code
- Blockquotes
- Tables
- Links and images
- Horizontal rules

Image paths are resolved relative to the Markdown file location when possible.

Formatting Commands

Use the **Format** menu to transform selected text or insert placeholders at the caret.

Available commands include:

- Bold
- Italic
- Bold Italic
- Strikethrough
- Inline Code
- Code Block
- Blockquote
- Heading 1 through Heading 6
- Bullet List
- Numbered List
- Task List
- Completed Task
- Horizontal Rule
- Clear Formatting

Line-based commands operate on the current line or selected lines.

Insert Commands

Use the **Insert** menu to add Markdown snippets:

- Link
- Image
- Table
- Bullet List
- Numbered List
- Task List
- Horizontal Rule
- Date
- Time
- Date and Time

The link command prompts for link text and URL. The image command prompts for an image file and alt text. Glance inserts a relative path when the image is near the current Markdown file. The table command asks how many columns to create.

If text is selected, inserted snippets are placed before the selected text instead of replacing it.

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+O	Open File
Ctrl+Shift+O	Open Folder
Ctrl+S	Save File
Ctrl+Shift+S	Save All
Ctrl+W	Close Tab
Ctrl+P	Print
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y	Redo
Ctrl+X	Cut

Ctrl+C	Copy
Ctrl+V	Paste
Ctrl+A	Select All
Ctrl+B	Bold
Ctrl+I	Italic
Ctrl+K	Insert Link
F1	Help

Saving Preview HTML

Use **Help > Save Preview HTML** to save the raw HTML generated for the current preview.

This is useful for debugging rendering issues or exporting a lightweight preview document.

Printing

Use **File > Print** to print the raw Markdown text. Rendered preview printing can be added later.

Troubleshooting

If preview styling appears limited, your system may be using the **wxHtmlWindow** fallback. Installing the wxWidgets WebView development package enables a stronger HTML engine where available.

On Debian or Ubuntu, install:

```
sudo apt install libwxgtk-webview3.2-dev
```

Then rerun CMake and rebuild the application.